

November 28th 2017 Delaware County Council Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Bn2QB8U7rvU
Publication Date	2017-11-29T18:18:16Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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County Council Meeting Report

Meeting Date: October 28 (Year not explicitly stated, referenced in transcript as 2017/2018 budget cycles)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the County Council meeting to order at [00:00:07](#) at 9:01 a.m.
- **Attendance:**
 - *Presiding Officer:* Not explicitly named in opening roll call, but active members participating include Mr. Alexander, Mr. Bledsoe, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lassiter, Mr. Magic, Mr. Piper, and Mr. Quicken (or variations thereof in roll calls).
 - *Members Present:* Mr. Alexander, Mr. Bledsoe, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lassiter, Mr. Magic, Mr. Piper, Mr. Quicken.
 - *Members Absent:* None noted during roll call.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:12](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:**

- Minutes of the October 24th meeting were approved on a roll call vote (00:01:40).
 - Minutes of the 2018 budget hearings were approved on a roll call vote (00:02:15).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Financial Agenda & Budget Transfers

- **00:02:38 Circuit Court Transfer (Petit Jurors)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily / Court Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Originally requested \$20,000 for petit jurors, but amended the request downward to \$13,500 due to canceled trials. Unused funds will revert to County General.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Unanimous among present members).
- **00:05:01 Sheriff's Department Educational Incentive & Budget Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff's Department / Council members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Extensive debate regarding funding for merit employees, educational incentives (\$39,000 total request), and jail budget transfers. Staff and council negotiated line-item adjustments, utilizing transfers from jail and sheriff budgets alongside council salary adjustment funds (\$4,474).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Additional appropriation of \$14,335 approved via amended motion (00:27:07); subsequent specific budget transfers for the sheriff and jail incentive funds were approved by Roll Call Vote (00:28:31, 01:06:57).
- **00:32:12 Auditor Postage Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$2,990.52 for postage costs.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (00:32:42).
- **00:33:03 EDIT (Economic Development Income Tax) Projects**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Auditor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Total request of \$3,000,000 to cover EDIT projects and bond payments while maintaining minimum operating balances.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (00:34:37).
- **00:35:00 Council/Part-Time Project Fund**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requests for part-time staffing lines totaling \$30,720 (\$10,835 and \$20,184 adjusted).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (00:35:57).
- **00:36:14 County Coroner Health Care Insurance Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Coroner's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer request of \$26,000 for health care insurance.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (00:36:40).
- **00:36:54 EMS Capital Improvement & Overtime Funding**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** EMS Department / Jason.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Total request of \$86,565 (\$14,565 capital improvements, \$60,000 overtime, \$12,000 gas/fuel). Lengthy discussion ensued regarding EMS fund ordinances, staff retention, competition with private ambulance services offering sign-on bonuses, rising equipment costs (e.g., power-load stretcher systems), and high call volumes straining paramedics. Finance committee gave no initial recommendation, but the board debated and processed the appropriation.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (00:43:37). Subsequent FICA add-on for EMS overtime (\$930) also approved (00:59:59).
- **01:00:12 Supplies and Equipment Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Department representatives.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request of \$45,000 (\$5,000 supplies, \$40,000 equipment).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (01:00:39).
- **01:00:52 Juvenile UI Operation Pullover**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Juvenile Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Salary request of \$9,000.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (01:01:17).
- **01:01:24 Rainy Day Fund (Tax Warrant Interest)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor / Treasurer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request of \$40,000 for tax warrant interest. Discussion on paying off the advance draw early to save on interest.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (01:05:56).
- **01:06:21 Committee-Recommended Routine Financial Transfers (En Masse)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Finance Committee.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A series of housekeeping and line-item transfers for the Coroner, Drainage Board, EMS, Jail, Public Defender, Sheriff, Treasurer, Highway, Fair Board, and Community Corrections were presented with Finance Committee recommendations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (01:16:04).

5. Ordinances & Resolutions

- **01:18:05 Ordinance No. 2017-33: Annual Tax Anticipation / Authorization of Auditor**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Legal Counsel (Mr. Hughes) / Auditor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual ordinance authorizing the auditor regarding tax anticipation/warrants. Received first and second readings.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**

- First Reading: Approved on Roll Call Vote (01:19:36).
 - Second Reading: Approved on Roll Call Vote (01:21:05).
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6. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *Note: No distinct citizen public comment period featuring external members of the public occurred; discussions were strictly confined to board members, department heads (Sheriff, EMS Director Jason, Public Defender Office Manager Shelly Garvey), and staff.*
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7. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Shelly Garvey (Public Defender Office Manager) provided a brief third-quarter reimbursement report update (01:24:30).
 - Discussion held regarding scheduling the annual Ted Bowman competitive meeting/dinner (01:31:42).
 - Members discussed local government comparisons with Evansville regarding jail overcrowding and state reimbursement rates (\$35/day) for housing state inmates (01:28:14).
 - **Adjournment:** Motion to adjourn passed; meeting concluded as members prepared for upcoming holiday travel/schedules (01:34:12).
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